

## ? What Do You Want To Do Today?

**I want to read PDF files:** Use Acrobat Reader (type `acroread` in the Run window) or KPDF (KPDF in the Run window)

**I want to zip and unzip files:** Use Karchiver (type `karchiver` in the Run window) or Ark (ark in Run window)

**I want a good calculator:** Kcalc offers exponential, logical, trigonometric, and statistical functions apart from the regular arithmetic. Type `kcalc` in the Run window

**I want to take screenshots:** KSnapshot, `ksnapshot` in Run window, should do the trick

**I want something similar to Windows Notepad:** Kate is a good text editor. With a view to helping programmers, it has some project management options apart from an inbuilt Linux terminal. Type `kate` to launch it

**I want an XML editor:** TXMLEditor should be

enough. Type `kxmleditor` at the Run window

**I want to sync my Palm handheld:** KPilot offers familiar sections for your Palm To-dos, Memos and Addresses. It can also push applications to the handheld. Type `kpilot` on the Run window to launch it

**I want an alarm:** KAlarm lets you set up alarms. These can be triggered at specific times that are set, and can be made to recur. Alerts take the form of both audio files such as Ogg or Real Audio, apart from a visual alert. The alarms can also be set to trigger the launch of an application or send an e-mail. Type `kalarm` at the Run window to launch the app

**I want an audio player:** amarok was our favourite player under KDE. It is fast, has a simple interface, and supports features such as an on-screen-display for song names.

Type `amarok` on the Run window

**I want to burn a CD/DVD:** K3b is the easy choice here. It can burn both CDs and DVDs, has a wizard to take you through the steps and it works. Type `k3b` at the Run command to launch this one

**I want a video player:** Kaffeine is our choice of the bunch. You will have to download codecs for some files. But that is the case with all the players under KDE. Type `kaffeine` to launch it

**An IDE for programming:** KDevelop is the best you have, like it or not. Type `kdevelop` in Run to launch it

**An image editor:** GIMP is your best bet. It rivals Adobe Photoshop over certain features. It offers layers, has lots of plugins, fonts, scripts, etc to make image-editing really easy

share documents with others not using the same suite. As a workaround though, you can easily export an OOo file to a PDF for sharing with outside clients.

Before deciding to switch to OOo, make sure you run a comprehensive test. As a worst-case scenario, if you can't work without MS Office, consider that you can use WINE to run MS Office within a Linux distribution.

This discussion on compatibility is equally true for all aspects of the OOo suite—right from the word processor to the presentation tool.

### WRITER

**OOo-writer** in Run window

Writer is an excellent replacement for Microsoft Word. It does everything that Word can do, and has a few tricks that it can teach the Windows behemoth. One of the most interesting ones is that of auto-completion. It maintains a database of all the words that you have typed over a period of time. Writer offers to complete the words whenever it identifies those that are repeated. The idea is to boost the typing speed. Tools that offer auto-correction and



**It is impossible to find 100 per cent compatibility between OpenOffice.org and MS Office**

spell-check are also present, in the Tools menu.

If you are accustomed to MS Word, you will miss some useful touches such as the right-click access to the thesaurus or the ability to hit a shortcut key to get the word count for a document. Right-click on the Main toolbar located on the left, and click on Configure. Then click on the Keyboard tab of the dialog box that shows up. This is where you can assign shortcuts to frequently-used commands. For example, assign [Ctrl] + [W] to give you the word count of a document.

There are several other features as well. You can directly export to the PDF format (File > Export as PDF). Writer also has a series of wizards to automate tasks located under File > AutoPilot. These let you perform tasks such as conversion of files from MS or OOo formats to the OOo XML format, create memos, import new dictionaries, etc.

NOTE: If you find that you can't edit anything with Writer, go to the Edit File icon (right next to the Export as PDF icon) and click on it.

### CALC

**OOo-calc** in Run window

As Writer to MS Word, Calc is just as worthy a replacement for MS Excel, as far as functionality is concerned. Another benefit is that of a uniform interface between the OOo suite applications. This extends to both toolbars and the menu structure.

You won't face problems exchanging data from one application to another. A Calc table or

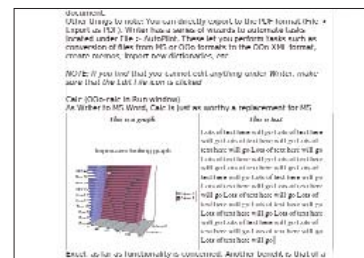


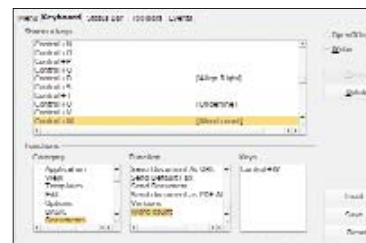
Table from Calc within Writer

chart is there to co-exist within a Writer document. Just as Writer, Calc can also export a spreadsheet as a PDF file.

### IMPRESS

**OOo-impress** in Run window

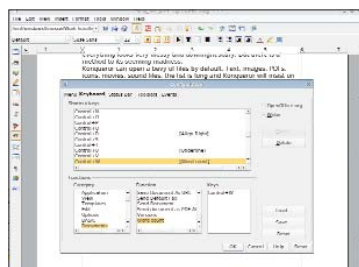
Impress is the presentation tool. As you launch it, Impress takes you through a rudimentary wizard. But, the templates available



Impress is not very impressive

are minimal, and the wizard itself isn't quite useful. Despite that, Impress is a decent tool, with several interesting features. You can add text animations, page transitions, sound effects—the usual whiz-bang to add the gee-whiz to your presentations. It is not comprehensive by far, but it is good enough to get the task done. ■

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Associating shortcuts to frequent commands is simple